Spring 2011

The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume X Issue 2

Calendar of Events

President's Message

By Jackson Bain

When looking at the damage from the terrible storms in the mid-West and the South , we count ourselves lucky once again that no major storms have come our way this past year. This has certainly been a period in which we all kept a cautious eye on the weather, and we also prepare for whatever Mother Nature might bring. CMA will continue to examine ways to protect our



infrastructure from such potential damage, and our coming installation of new, more robust control systems for our water supply is part of that work. But, there is more—and it is your responsibility. Emergencies happen and your using the new house number signs CMA has provided will help guide rescue crews and help to your home in case of a personal or natural disaster. I appreciate CMA VP Arnold Weinberg 's leadership in pushing homeowners to make this small but critical addition to your property. Please make certain those house numbers are up and positioned at the beginning of your drive. As Summer arrives, so does fire season, and again, your preparation and care about fire in our community—inside your house and outside—could help prevent a widespread disaster.

Best regards,

Jackson

Special Newsletter Features

You may notice a few special features in our newsletter. Some of the ideas were from our members. Jason Geno thought it would be a good idea to hear from our youngest members, so we have ***Coolfont Kids.*** Flo Merola thought adding recipes from our members' potluck dinners would be a fun and delicious addition to the newsletter. CMA members comprise three different groups—full timers, second home owners and those who mainly rent their homes. I thought, let's here why full timers chose Coolfont as their home. Cathy Levey volunteered to be the first to write about being a full time resident.

Enjoy these new features!

Ask Not What CMA Can Do For You, Ask What You Can Do For CMA

Nominations Sought for the Fall 2011 Election

By Rusty McCrady

With the CMA Board elections just months away, now is the time to declare your own candidacy or nominate someone else to run for a position on the Board. Considering that our Board of Directors will have four vacancies, this is the year to run for office. So I hope you will talk to me in person over the summer, or write to me: rusty.mccrady@gmail.com if you are interested in the election process and/or would like to inquire about running for office. We hope to have at least four new candidates by August. We'll conduct voting by mail in September, and then tabulate votes at the annual membership meeting in October. Like to hear from members who live here full time and members who rent their homes to run for a board position.



Calendar of Events

May 14

10 AM Pool Beautification Day

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May 27

Opening of Pool

May 28

Board Meeting

10 AM CMA Office

May 29

Memorial Day Hot Dog/Hamburger Picnic

May 28, 29, 30

Berkeley Springs Studio Tour

10 AM-5 PM

May 29

Peter Basquin Concert

4 pm

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June, no board meeting

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July 3

July 4 Hot Dog/Hamburger Picnic

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July 9

Board Meeting

10 AM CMA Office

Potluck—Lois & Jay Copeland

6:30 PM K-1 Shalom

****

August 20

Board Meeting

10 AM CMA Office

Potluck—Evelyn and Denny Brydges

6:30 PM Q-4 Hooters

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The Coolfont Mountainside Association Listserv

By Lois Copeland

Last Spring CMA set up a listserv for members of our community. I was asked to help with this project as Chair of the Communications Committee. I actually did not know what a listserv was, but I did know how to google. Computers can be amazing, for in less than a minute a huge list of sites appeared—what is a listserv, how do they work and listings of Associations and their listserv.

I did learn that listservs have guidelines and most of the guidelines are very similar. Below is a list of the guidelines for our listserv and will shortly appear on our website and listserv. This was approved by our Board.

Purpose

The CMA listserv is a public forum to post notices, seek and disseminate general information, discuss topics of interest to residents of the community, ask questions, voice concerns and encourage participation for the betterment of our community.

Permitted Uses

*Homeowner looking for contractor references

*Individuals (not realtors) seeking housing or homeowners houses to rent or for sale.

*Announcing rummage/garage sales

*Expressing concerns about neighborhood & community issues.

*Announcing small items to give away or sell on a non-regular basis.

Not Permitted Uses

*Advertising, marketing or promoting business services or products.

*Posts seeking clients or business opportunities, such as realtors seeking homes for rent or sale, or realtors seeking clients or offering homes for rent or sale or seeking homes to sell or rent.

*Advertising of services for home maintenance, web maintenance, web services.

*Political endorsements or campaign posting.

By virtue of joining this group or posting to the discussions or using the listserv, you have agreed to follow these etiquette guidelines.

Board reserves the right to suspend listserv membership for anyone who repeatedly violates one or more of these guidelines.



I think the listserv has served the purpose set forward in these guidelines. It has brought our community together. Important discussions take place as well as answers to questions that sometimes

Report from the Pool Committee

By Bob Cohen

The CMA pool will open for the season on Friday, May 27 and we plan to have our annual hotdog/hamburger picnic at the pool on Sunday, May 29.

This year, Emily Hornbaker and Sarah Wagner will return to serve as lifeguards. Jared Levi will serve as a backup guard, when needed. Erin Cheatham, who recently went through the training course to become a Certified Pool Operator (CPO) will be responsible for monitoring the quality of water in the pools.

Other changes that have been made to the pool include:

- A French drain was dug to prevent the lawn from becoming soggy.
- The grassy areas have been seeded and fertilized.
- Eight new shrubs have been planted to hide the utility pipes.
- New flowers will be planted during the Pool Clean-Up Day May 14.
- The installation of WiFi at the pool is being negotiated.

We hope to have a successful and beautiful summer enjoying our pool.

Pool will look very different in a few weeks!



DACC Report

By Flo Bender Merola

A reminder from Flo.

We all know that large trees as well as small shrubs are vital to the environment. No trees larger than 6 inches in diameter, may be cut, trimmed, or topped without written approval from the DACC. If you have a tree that may pose a danger of falling on a structure, driveway, or road please contact me. I'll check it out promptly and approve the removal before it can do any danger.

Can the tree on the right be trimmed? No, not without permission from DACC , it's larger than 6" in diameter.



Morgan County Directive Regarding Signage

By Arnold Weinberg

Morgan County has made it official: "All homeowners are expected to install house numbers in a location that is visible to Emergency Responders."

DACC chairperson Flo Merola and I have conducted a survey of the Mountainside, recording the houses that do not have their house numbers mounted and visible from the road. We will re-survey the Mountainside on July 1st.

Contact Shane Cheatham for pick up and/or installation, 304-258-2984.

Morgan County Directive

A road sign needs to be installed, which is the responsibility of the landowners who use the road. The correct marking of the road saves valuable seconds when emergency responders are trying to locate you in a life threatening situation. All parties involved are encouraged to place the road sign as soon as possible.

How to Display My Address

A. When each house or building has been assigned its respective address, the owner, occupant, or agent shall place or cause to be placed upon each house or building controlled by him the number, or number assigned under the uniform numbering system. Such 911 assigned city style address number shall be placed on all buildings for residential occupancy. Such number shall be placed on new building prior to occupancy. The cost of posing the address shall be the responsibility of the property owner.

B. The number shall be conspicuously placed on, above or at the side of the main entrance so that the number is discernible from the street.



Notice how the house number is placed by the driveway and discernible from the street.

Whenever a building is more that fifty (50) feet from the street or when the entrance is not visible from the street, the number shall also be placed along a walk, driveway, or another suitable location so that the address number is discernible from the street. Where mailboxes are not affixed to the building, street address numbers shall be shown thereon in accordance with postal regulations.

C. Street address numbers or letters shall be of a contrasting color to the background on which the numbers are mounted.

The Red Spruce Tree

By Craig Deane

The Spruce forest is an important part of West Virginia natural history. At one time, Red Spruce covered more than 500,000 acres of mountain ground here. Spruce was used in fine instruments like fiddles, guitars and pianos. Due to its light weight and strong unknotted wood, it was also used in ship building. Even the Wright Brothers purchased West Virginia Red Spruce for their airplanes.

Spruce is also an important habitat for the Northern Flying Squirrel and a great nesting area for birds.

During the nineteenth century the spruces were heavily logged here. Today only about 10% of West Virginia Red Spruce forest remains and it is great to have a small stand of spruces here for us to enjoy.



The Red Spruce

Gateways Committee April 2011

The Gateway Committee is charged with improving the appearance of the Mountainside entrance ways and key community facilities with an eye to enhancing the mountainside and, by extension, the members property values. Last year we cleared, painted, and otherwise tidied the main entrance kiosk area, cleared underbrush and pruned the overgrown roadside evergreen patch at the intersection of Herbert Quick Drive and Mountainside, and cleared the overgrown embankment in front of the tennis courts and stained the steps while eliminating some related steps/ walking hazards.

The effort also did something for the environmentalists among us. Craig Dean, who "bossed" the actual work, advises me there are a number of native Red Spruce in the roadside evergreen patch and in front of the courts.

Currently we will be removing some more brush at the Herbert Quick intersection and elsewhere at a few spots along Mountainside, and doing a major face lift for the parking lot & green space area around the Barn. The growing brush pile beyond the evergreens which is resulting from all this will be duly burned once snow is on the ground again.



(see the above article for additional information)

Cooking at Coolfont

Flo and Larry Merola are happy to share their recipe for biscotti with CMA members. It's fun to bake and a favorite to eat with their students at Villa Firenze.

BISCOTTI

2 1/2 cups all purpose flour

2 tsp baking powder

1/4 cup butter

1 cup sugar

3 eggs

2+ tbsp anise extract

1 tsp salt

corn meal for dusting pan

*8 oz nuts

Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Grease large cookie sheet and sprinkle with corn meal to prevent sticking. Sift flour, salt and baking powder and set aside. In another bowl beat the butter and sugar at medium speed until very light. Add eggs one at a time, beating well after each addition. Beat in the anise extract. Add the nuts. *You may use almonds, pistachio nuts or any nut of your choice. You may even add chocolate chips and/or dried cranberries. This is where your creativity comes in! Add the flour mixture and beat at low speed until blended. Divide mixture into 3 loaves on the cookie sheet and bake for approximately 25 min. Remove from oven, cool, cut diagonally into 1/2 inch slices and rebake with cut side down until brown. Biscotti means twice baked. Makes approximately 30 pieces.



Larry baking his delicious biscotti.

Peter Basquin Piano Recital

Internationally acclaimed virtuoso pianist, Peter Basquin, will present a solo piano rectal Sunday, May 29 at 4:00 p.m. in The Presbyterian Church in Berkeley Springs, WV. The recital includes classical works for piano by J.S. Bach, Ludwig van Beethoven, Frederic Chopin and Samuel Barber.

Mr. Basquin said, "I am delighted to be coming back to Berkeley Springs and my many friends there one more time."

An artist familiar to many area classical music lovers, Peter Basquin was an artist-in-residence for more than 25 years at the Manor House summer concerts sponsored by the Coolfont Foundation. After Coolfont closed its doors, he continued to offer a recital each spring in Berkeley Springs on the Yamaha grand piano donated to the Presbyterian Church by Samuel Ashelman and Martha Work Ashelman.

Mr. Basquin's 2011 rectal is sponsored by **FAST** (Morgan County Forum for Arts, Sciences and Technologies) and the Friends of Church on the Hill Concerts.

The public is welcome to attend the recital and meet Peter and Katie Basquin at a reception following the concert. There is no admission charge for this Church on the Hill concert. Donations are encouraged to support the continuation of the Church on the Hill Concert series. The Presbyterian Church is located at 101 S. Mercer Street. For more information, contact Lydia Walker at 304-258-3031.



"I have seen Peter Basquin many times, including at the Manor House. He never ceases to amaze me," says Lois Copeland

The New Trails are being Blazed

We have recently completed a new White trail, which starts at Dogwood (Dogwood pump) and ends at Bobcat. This is considered a medium level in difficulty and can be hiked by families.

Our next trail we will clean up is the old blue trail that leads directly up the mountain to the Cacapon fire road. This trail will be blazed by end of May and is a more strenuous trail. Once both trails are complete we will be posting trail maps on the CMA website. I want to thank Craig Deane and his Company for completing the trail work and scheduling time to assist us with other recreational tasks at CMA.



Follow the white markings on the tree as shown in this picture.

The Musings of a Full Timer

By Cathy Levey

I thought it would be interesting to find out why our full time residents chose to live at Coolfont. Below is Cathy Levey's reason why she chose Coolfont. I would love to here from other full time residents on "why Coolfont".

The initial impression here at Coolfont is of a feeling of grief and loss, a longing for a time past when Coolfont was young and vibrant and even exciting. With time, it seemed loss became the predominant experience. Yet, with a willingness to look a little deeper, one discovers another community that has been here all along and continues to define itself. It is a community where the rules are pretty simple. Those of us who live here full time (as well as those of us who experience Coolfont as a second home) recognize those rules: we accept each other as we are with all our flaws, eccentricities and quirkiness. We respect each other's privacy but also know we are there for each other without question. We allow each other to be who we are without trying to impose our own belief systems on each other and, in doing so, learn from each other and come to appreciate the various perspectives and experiences we each bring.

I have arrived at a profound gratitude for the community of Coolfont. It allows me the freedom and privacy to reflect on past events, however painful and



charged, and explore long held beliefs that no longer serve, thus, finding a peace and reconciliation that has, up to now, eluded me. Even the most grievous of issues is balanced by the lightness of the spirit here, a spirit honed and developed by all the individuals who have visited this wonderful place for retreat and regeneration. That essence of lightness inspires me to believe everything will ultimately resolve in peace! My husband describes Coolfont as our own little secret garden, where we are tucked away and protected from some of the more violent aspects of life. At night, we sleep in the pitch dark and silence and the absence of all that distracts from the essence of life. It has become a place where self-reflection, introspection and thoughtfulness are supported.

And, when one wearies of the introspection, the attractions of Berkeley Springs (restaurants, movies, plays, art spas, antiques, the farmers market, etc.) are there to capture you and, if that's not enough, Winchester, Hagerstown, Frederick, the Metropolitan area and beyond call to the restless spirit. Finally, don't forget the community special events of pot lucks and pool parties and general get-togethers!

If you look closely and carefully enough you will see in Coolfont the face of an elder, wrinkled and aged, yet full of the gift so precious in those who have aged well: a wisdom, a grace, an acceptance and the peace that comes from having had the opportunity to go inward and reconcile with life. And you realize there is still a remarkable and awe-inspiring here; it is just different now.

Gat Caperton no longer lives at Coolfont, he lived here full time for a while. He added his thoughts to full time living on the mountainside.

Although we have moved to town, we can still recommend living at Coolfont full time. Moving to town helped with the logistics of having young kids. We liked everything about living on Bobcat.

Plus, we selfishly liked having you in the community more.

-Gat

Coolfont Kids

By Olivia and Elise Geno

It's fun being a Coolfont Kid. We find all kinds of things to do in Coolfont and Berkeley Springs. Some favorite activities that we want to pass along to other kids visiting include:

A) Hiking on the trails at both Coolfont and Cacapon. The White Trail is fun, we look for frogs and different kinds of flowers.

B) Playing on the play ground equipment and using the meadow or "magic meadow" as we call it to play soccer. Our family soccer game is always fun because we usually beat mom and dad.

C) Splashing at the pool. Nothing is better than jumping into the pool on a hot summer day.

D) Making sand castles at the Cacapon beach. We make huge sand castles or play in the lake.

E) And the Roman Baths at Berkeley Springs State Park. We enjoy the baths winter or summer. We think it's cool that George Washington took his bath there.





Coolfont Mountainside Association

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Where is Bath?

When George Washington and his colonial colonies cronies established a town around the warm springs in 1776 , they called it Bath after the famed Bath in England. Since there was a town of Bath south along the Blue Ridge the town was called Berkeley Springs. But Bath remains the official municipal name.

Bath was born for the express purpose of encouraging the purchasers to build convenient houses for accommodating numbers of infirm persons, who frequent those springs yearly for the recovery of their health. Bath was an early economic development project aimed at supporting tourism.

As in 1776 we encourage all to take in the baths to support Berkeley Springs or is it the town of Bath.



Bits and Pieces

By Lois Copeland

Berkeley Springs Studio Tour

The spring studio tour, May 28-30, you explore the noted arts community of Berkeley Springs with a mapped, self-guided tour of more than 25 studios and shops throughout the county. Check in at the **Ice House** Art Center in downtown Berkeley Springs. Tour 10am to 5pm.



Quilt Month

May 6—June 12. Delectable Mountains 30th Anniversary Quilt Show: *Pearls*. On Sunday May 29 @ 2pm there will be a Yard Square Quilt Auction sponsored by the Delectable Mountain Quilt Guild.



Art In The Park

May 1, June 5, July 3 & 17, Aug 7 & 21, September 4 & 18 and October 2.

Straight from the Bay

Last year **Straight from the Bay** opened up a seafood business in a trailer by the Old Antiques Mall selling crabs straight from the bay, shrimp, slaw, etc. The prices were good, owners friendly and the seafood delicious. Crabs are made Maryland style with Old Bay Seasoning. Last year a group of us ordered a few dozen crabs and spiced shrimp for an old fashion Maryland style crab feast.

Now **Straight from the Bay** has opened up a restaurant on 51 Independence Ave. for lunch and dinner and take-out. They have a wonderful salad bar, crab cake sandwiches and shrimp. Shortly we will see our own Maryland blue crabs.

